
The Sport Psychologist's Handbook

A Guide for Sport-Specific Performance Enhancement

Edited by
Joaquín Dosil



John Wiley & Sons, Ltd

Copyrighted material

This is a preview. The total pages displayed will be limited.

The Sport Psychologist's Handbook

A Guide for Sport-Specific Performance Enhancement

Edited by
Joaquín Dosil

Copyright © 2006 John Wiley & Sons Ltd, The Atrium, Southern Gate, Chichester,
West Sussex PO19 8SQ, England
Telephone (+44) 1243 779777

Chapter 24 © 2006 University of Missouri-St Louis

Email (for orders and customer service enquiries): cs-books@wiley.co.uk
Visit our Home Page on www.wiley.com

All Rights Reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, scanning or otherwise, except under the terms of the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988 or under the terms of a licence issued by the Copyright Licensing Agency Ltd, 90 Tottenham Court Road, London W1T 4LP, UK, without the permission in writing of the Publisher. Requests to the Publisher should be addressed to the Permissions Department, John Wiley & Sons Ltd, The Atrium, Southern Gate, Chichester, West Sussex PO19 8SQ, England, or emailed to permreq@wiley.co.uk, or faxed to (+44) 1243 770620.

Designations used by companies to distinguish their products are often claimed as trademarks. All brand names and product names used in this book are trade names, service marks, trademarks or registered trademarks of their respective owners. The Publisher is not associated with any product or vendor mentioned in this book.

This publication is designed to provide accurate and authoritative information in regard to the subject matter covered. It is sold on the understanding that the Publisher is not engaged in rendering professional services. If professional advice or other expert assistance is required, the services of a competent professional should be sought.

Other Wiley Editorial Offices

John Wiley & Sons Inc., 111 River Street, Hoboken, NJ 07030, USA

Jossey-Bass, 989 Market Street, San Francisco, CA 94103-1741, USA

Wiley-VCH Verlag GmbH, Boschstr. 12, D-69469 Weinheim, Germany

John Wiley & Sons Australia Ltd, 42 McDougall Street, Milton, Queensland 4064, Australia

John Wiley & Sons (Asia) Pte Ltd, 2 Clementi Loop #02-01, Jin Xing Distripark, Singapore 129809

John Wiley & Sons Canada Ltd, 22 Worcester Road, Etobicoke, Ontario, Canada M9W 1L1

Wiley also publishes its books in a variety of electronic formats. Some content that appears in print may not be available in electronic books.

Library of Congress Cataloging-in-Publication Data

The sport psychologist's handbook : a guide for sport-specific
performance enhancement / edited by Joaquín Dosil.

p. cm.

Includes bibliographical references and index.

ISBN-13: 978-0-470-86355-8 (cloth : alk. paper)

ISBN-10: 0-470-86355-2 (cloth : alk. paper)

ISBN-13: 978-0-470-86356-5 (pbk. : alk. paper)

ISBN-10: 0-470-86356-0 (pbk. : alk. paper)

1. Sports—Psychological aspects—Handbooks, manuals, etc. I. Dosil, Joaquín.

GV706.4.S675 2005

796.01—dc22

2005015432

British Library Cataloguing in Publication Data

A catalogue record for this book is available from the British Library

ISBN-13 978-0-470-86355-8 (hbk) 978-0-470-86356-5 (pbk)

ISBN-10 0-470-86355-2 (hbk) 0-470-86356-0 (pbk)

Typeset in 10/12pt Times by TechBooks, New Delhi, India

Printed and bound in Great Britain by Antony Rowe Ltd, Chippenham, Wiltshire

This book is printed on acid-free paper responsibly manufactured from sustainable forestry in which at least two trees are planted for each one used for paper production.

Contents

About the Editor	ix
Contributors	xi
Foreword	xxi
Preface	xxv
Acknowledgments	xxvii

Part I Introduction to Working with Athletes

Chapter 1	Applied Sport Psychology: A New Perspective <i>Joaquín Dosil</i>	3
Chapter 2	Enhancing Coach–Athlete Relationships: Cognitive-Behavioral Principles and Procedures <i>Frank L. Smoll and Ronald E. Smith</i>	19
Chapter 3	Providing Sport Psychology Services to Families <i>David N. Sacks, Gershon Tenenbaum and David Pargman</i>	39
Chapter 4	An Overview of Interventions in Sport <i>Robert N. Singer and Mark H. Anshel</i>	63
Chapter 5	Assessment, Evaluation and Counseling in Sport	89

vi

CONTENTS

Chapter 10	Psychological Aspects in the Training and Performance of Team Handball Athletes <i>John M. Silva</i>	211
Chapter 11	Skill Learning from an Expertise Perspective: Issues and Implications for Practice and Coaching in Cricket <i>Sean Müller and Bruce Abernethy</i>	245

Part III Individual Sports

Chapter 12	The Psychology of Athletics <i>Joaquín Dosil</i>	265
Chapter 13	Sport Psychology and Tennis <i>Robert Weinberg</i>	285
Chapter 14	Golf: Sport Psychology Challenges <i>Linda K. Bunker</i>	301
Chapter 15	Psychology of Cycling <i>Jim Taylor and Jeff Kress</i>	325

Part IV Combat Sports

Chapter 16	Application of Sport Psychology for Optimal Performance in Martial Arts <i>Mark H. Anshel and John M. Payne</i>	353
Chapter 17	Psychological Factors and Mental Skills in Wrestling <i>Brent S. Rushall</i>	375

Part V Winter Sports

Chapter 18	Sport Psychological Consulting in Ice Hockey <i>Wayne Halliwell, Len Zaichkowsky and Cal Botterill</i>	403
Chapter 19	A Mental Preparation Guide for Figure Skaters: A Developmental Approach <i>Eva V. Monsma and Deborah L. Feltz</i>	427

Part VI Water Sports

Chapter 20	The Sport Psychology of Olympic Sailing and Windsurfing <i>Ian Maynard</i>	457
Chapter 21	Psychological Aspects of Rowing <i>Michael Kellmann, Gaby Bußmann, Dorothee Anders and Sebastian Schulte</i>	479
Chapter 22	High Performance Thinking for Professional Surfers <i>Michael Martin</i>	503

Part VII Motor Sports

- Chapter 23 Psychological Training in Motorcycling 527
Joaquín Dosil and Enrique J. Garcés de Los Fayos

Part VIII Shooting Sports

- Chapter 24 Psychological Aspects of Archery 549
Kathleen M. Haywood

Part IX Equestrian Sports

- Chapter 25 Of Two Minds: Consulting with the Horse-and-Rider Team in Dressage, Showjumping and Polo 569
Grace Pretty and Don Bridgeman

Part X Fitness Sports

- Chapter 26 Sport Psychology and Fitness Activities 589
Diane L. Gill
- Chapter 27 Psychology and Bodybuilding 617
Dave Smith
- Chapter 28 Sport Psychology in Gymnastics 641
Karen D. Cogan

Part XI Sports for Athletes with Disabilities

- Chapter 29 Providing Sport Psychology Support for Athletes with Disabilities 665
Mark Bawden

Part XII Afterword

- Chapter 30 It's All About Sport Performance . . . and Something Else 687
Mark B. Andersen

- Index 699

About the Editor

Dr. Joaquín Dosil is a professor at the University of Vigo in Northwest Spain and head of the doctoral course: "Current Perspectives of Physical Activity and Sport Psychology". His areas of research interest include peak performance in different sports, eating disorders in sport, cyberpsychology of sport, and referees' sport psychology. He is a foundation member and the current President of the Ibero-American Society of Sport Psychology (SIPD), as well as a member of the International Society of Sport Psychology. He is on the editorial board for the two most important sport psychology journals in Spain, along with various sport science reviews. Dr. Dosil is the Director of a sport psychology unit in Santiago de Compostela, where he attends athletes and sport teams from various modalities and levels. In particular he works with many Olympic athletes, golfers, world-leading motorcyclists and tennis players, while directing psychological programmes with various professional football and basketball teams. He has published 11 sport psychology books—most notably, the leading text in the Hispanic world: *Psicología de la Actividad Física y del Deporte (Psychology of Physical Activity and Sport)*, published by McGraw-Hill—and has produced over 70 articles and chapters. Professor Dosil frequently participates as a lecturer in international and national congresses, master's and doctoral degree programmes. He is an avid runner, specialising in distance events, particularly the half-marathon. In his free time, he enjoys spending time with his wife (Olivia), family and friends, as well as practicing surfing, beach volley, football, basketball and tennis.

Contributors

Bruce Abernethy is the Chair and Director of the Institute of Human Performance at the University of Hong Kong. Dr Abernethy is an international fellow of various scientific organisations such as the American Academy of Kinesiology and Physical Education. He is an editorial advisory board member of the *Journal of Sports Sciences*, past editor of the *Australian Journal of Science and Medicine in Sport*, and an editorial board member of several other sport psychology journals. Dr Abernethy has published extensively on the topic of movement expertise and skill learning focusing on perceptual aspects of skilled performance. Furthermore, he has experience in playing **cricket** to first-class (provincial) level.

Dorothee Anders is a postgraduate student at the University of Hamburg (Germany) and completed her master's degree in psychology in April 2005. Since 2003 she has been involved in the psychological consultation of the German Under 23 and Junior National Rowing Team as a trainee at the faculty of sports science at the University of Bochum and the Olimpiastutzpunkt Westfalen. Currently, she is working on "Stress, Recovery and Action Control in Rowing" for her thesis and to complete her work to become a certified sport psychologist.

Mark B. Andersen is a registered psychologist and Associate Professor at Victoria University in Melbourne (Australia). He teaches in the School of Human Movement and coordinates the master's and doctor of applied psychology degrees (sport and exercise psychology emphasis) in the School of Psychology. His areas of research interest include: the psychology of injury and rehabilitation; the role of exercise in mental health, wellbeing and quality of life; the training and supervision of graduate students; and the practice of sport psychology service delivery. He has published more than 100 refereed journal articles and book chapters and has made over 90 national and international conference presentations. His edited book *Doing Sport Psychology* is used around the world in graduate applied sport psychology programmes.

Mark H. Anshel is a professor at Middle Tennessee State University (USA). He has authored several books including *Sport Psychology: From Theory to Practice*. His numerous book chapters and research articles cover topics such as coping with stress, perfectionism, and drug use in sport, and strategies to promote exercise adherence. Dr Anshel is a member of various scientific societies such as the American Psychological Association and the Association for the Advancement of Applied Sport Psychology.

Mark Bawden is a sport psychologist who has been working in elite sport for 10 years. Mark was the Head Quarters Sport Psychologist for Great Britain at the Paralympics Games in Sydney (2002). He has worked with a range of paralympic sports including shooting,

table tennis and fencing. Mark also works with the English Cricket Board, the Great British Speed Skating Squad, the English Table Tennis Association, the English Amateur Boxing Association and the England Netball Association.

Cal Botterill has been a professor at the University of Winnipeg (Canada) since 1980. He is a member of many professional organizations including the International Society of Sport Psychology, the Association for the Advancement of Applied Sport Psychology (Certified Consultant) and the Canadian Mental Training Registry (Accredited). In his specialized field of ice hockey he has had experience working as a consultant at 7 different Olympic Games, with 10 different World Championship teams/athletes and with 5 different NHL Hockey Teams, to mention but a few. He has participated in over 200 international, national and regional conferences as a keynote speaker in sport, psychology, medicine, education and business. Author or co-author in over 120 publications, his current areas of scholarly interest include "perspectives in sport and life", "peak performance skills and attributes in sport and life" and "human potential and possibilities".

Don Bridgeman is a PhD candidate in the Department of Psychology at the University of Southern Queensland (Australia) where he is furthering previous equine studies including an associate diploma of applied science (horse husbandry), postgraduate diploma in applied science, and a research master's of applied science (animal studies). Don's research has included horse behaviour during abrupt weaning, isolation and transportation. He has since

He has also served as co-editor of seven editions of the *Directory of Graduate Programs in Applied Sport Psychology*. Dr Burke is currently an associate editor for the *Journal of Applied Sport Psychology*. He has been an intercollegiate basketball official and is a past member of the International Association of Approved Basketball Officials, completing 23 seasons as an interscholastic basketball official.

Gaby Bußmann works freelance as a sport psychologist in Germany. She wrote her dissertation on the problem of dropout in sport. For many years she has worked together with the Westphalia Olympic Training Centre. She looks after and supports world-class athletes in the field of psychology. In addition to her work at the Olympic Training Centre in Westphalia, Gaby Bussmann cooperates closely with the German events riders and the German national rowing team, along with Michael Kellmann. She also works with the German track and field association. Gaby Bussmann has been a world-class athlete in the past (track and field: 400 metres and 800 metres). She won a bronze medal at the Olympic Games in Los Angeles in 1984 with the 4 × 400 metres relay.

Karen D. Cogan is a licensed psychologist and holds a joint appointment at the University of North Texas (USA) Counseling Center and Psychology Department. She is on the faculty of the UNT Center for Sport Psychology and Performance Excellence and has a private practice. She is a certified consultant and currently consults with a variety of individual athletes and teams including the US Freestyle Mogul Ski team and the University of North Texas Athletic Department. In 2000, she published the book: *Sport Psychology Library: Gymnastics*. She is a member of the Association for the Advancement of Applied Sport Psychology and the American Psychological Association.

Deborah L. Feltz is a professor and chairperson in Kinesiology at Michigan State University (USA). She has research interests in the interrelationships among self-efficacy, anxiety, and motivation in sport and physical activity among youth, women and teams. She has published over 100 articles on these topics and received numerous awards for her work in these areas. In addition, Professor Feltz has served on several professional editorial boards, including the *Journal of Sport and Exercise Psychology*, *Research Quarterly for Exercise and Sport* (section editor), *Measurement in Physical Education and Exercise Science*, and *Quest*. She also served on the United States National Research Council's Committee on Techniques for the Enhancement of Human Performance and the sport psychology advisory committees to the United States Olympic Committee. Dr Feltz served as President of the American Academy of Kinesiology and Physical Education from 2000 to 2003 and is a fellow in the American Psychological Association.

Enrique Garcés de Los Fayos is a professor of sport psychology at the University of Murcia (Spain). He is Director of the journal *Cuadernos de Psicología del Deporte* and Director of the Sport Psychology Unit at the aforementioned university. Together with Joaquín Dosil, he is the author of two publications on applied psychology of motor sports, and applied psychological strategies for improved performance in motorcycling. He has also been a co-ordinator in general sport psychology texts such as *Manual de Psicología del Deporte: Concepto y Aplicaciones*, *Manual de Psicología del Deporte*, and *Áreas de Aplicación en Psicología del Deporte*. Moreover, he is a sport psychology member of the Official College of Psychologists in Murcia, as well as being a member of the State Co-ordinating Council of Sport Psychology, within the same organisation. Likewise, over recent years he

has worked directly with motorcyclists competing in Spanish and European motorcycling championships.

Diane L. Gill is a professor and graduate director in the Department of Exercise and Sport Science at the University of North Carolina at Greensboro (USA). Her research interests focus on physical activity and wellbeing across the lifespan, with an emphasis on social psychology, gender and cultural diversity. At UNCG she has served as Associate Dean of the School of Health and Human Performance, Head of the Department of Exercise and Sport Science, and as the founding Director of the Center for Women's Health and Wellness. She has over 100 publications including the text, *Psychological Dynamics of Sport and Exercise*, several book chapters, and many articles in research journals. She has presented over 100 research papers and invited addresses at national and international conferences, and received several awards for her research and professional work. She is a past-president of Division 47 (Exercise and Sport Psychology) of the American Psychological Association, a former president of the North American Society for the Psychology of Sport and Physical Activity and of the Research Consortium of AAHPERD, and former editor of the *Journal of Sport and Exercise Psychology*.

Wayne Halliwell is a professor in the Department of Kinesiology at the University of Montreal (Canada). He is a past-president of the Canadian Society of Psychomotor Learning and Sport Psychology and is also a fellow member of the Association for the Advancement of Applied Sport Psychology. For the past 20 years he has been the team sport psychology consultant with many of Hockey Canada's highly successful ice hockey teams at World Championships and Winter Olympic Games. He has also attended a number of Summer Olympic Games and the America's Cup as a consultant to the Canadian National Sailing Team. As the lead author of a recent book entitled *Consultant's Guide to Excellence*, Dr Halliwell and his colleagues provide insight into the art of delivering sport psychology consulting services to athletes, coaches and teams.

Tom Hanson is the founder of www.FocusedBaseball.com, a mental toughness resource for players, coaches and parents (2002). He has also been the full-time Performance Enhancement Director for the New York Yankees (2001), the Performance Enhancement Consultant for the Texas Rangers (1999, 2000), as well as providing performance enhancement services

CONTRIBUTORS

xv

with the Professional Archers Association, taking second place in one tournament. Now retired from active competition, she combines her competitive archery experience with her professional expertise in the psychological aspects of motor performance to author *Archery: Steps to Success*, with a third edition now in preparation, *Teaching Archery*, and two chapters related to teaching archery in secondary schools.

Ken Hodge is an associate professor in sport psychology at the School of Physical Education, University of Otago (New Zealand). His research focuses primarily on the psychosocial effects of participation in sport. Dr Hodge serves on editorial boards for the *Journal of Applied Sport Psychology* and the *Psychology of Sport and Exercise* journal. He currently works for the NZ Rugby Union (as a staff coach), and has worked for Netball NZ, NZ Swimming, and NZ Golf providing psychological skills training for a number of different teams and individuals. In 1992 he worked as Team Psychologist for the NZ Olympic Team at the Barcelona Games. Dr Hodge has written several books and has co-authored two rugby publications entitled *Thinking Rugby: Training Your Mind for Peak Performance*, and *Smart Training for Rugby: The Complete Rugby Training Guide*. He is a former president of the NZ Sport Psychology Association and also served as Deputy-Chairman of the NZ Federation of Sports Medicine from 1993 to 1995. Dr Hodge has 27 years' rugby playing experience and has 16 years' rugby coaching experience, as well as 15 years' experience teaching psychology skills to rugby players and coaches.

Michael Kellmann is an assistant professor of sport psychology in the Faculty of Sport Science at the Ruhr University of Bochum (Germany). He is a member of the Association for the Advancement of Applied Sport Psychology and German Psychological Association. He serves on the executive board of the German Association of Sport Psychology and the editorial board for *The Sport Psychologist*, the *German Journal of Sport Psychology*, and the *German Journal of Sport Medicine*. Dr Kellmann's works have appeared in more than 50 publications; he is co-author of *Recovery-Stress Questionnaire for Athletes: User Manual* and he edited the book *Enhancing Recovery: Preventing Underperformance in Athletes*. He has consulted with and conducted research for the National Sport Centre Calgary in Canada, the Olympic Training Centre Westphalia (Dortmund/Bochum), and the German national rowing team.

Jeff Kress earned both a master's of science degree and a doctor of philosophy degree in sport psychology and has done sport psychology consultation work with numerous teams and athletes. He is currently an assistant professor at California State University, Long Beach (USA). Dr Kress raced bicycles competitively for 15 years from the age of 15. During two of those years, he competed for the United States National Road Cycling Team, racing in such international stage races as the Tour of Belgium and the Vuelta de Chile.

Chris Lonsdale holds an MA and is a PhD candidate in sport psychology at the University of Otago (New Zealand). His areas of expertise include motivation, athlete burnout and psychological engagement in sport. Over the past seven years Chris has consulted with athletes in a variety of sports, including volleyball, ice hockey, athletics, tennis, golf, lawn bowling and equestrian. A former rugby player himself, Chris has also provided mental skills training for rugby union players at club, Super 12 and international levels. He is currently a mental skills consultant for Rugby Canada.

Michael Martin is Head of the Performance Psychology Department at the Australian Institute of Sport (Australia). He earned his PhD in sport psychology from the University of Wollongong. His main professional interests include exceeding client expectations, service delivery structures and mental skills. He has written over 50 articles for various journals, and on many occasions has written for the *Australian Surf Lifesaver*.

Ian Maynard took up the position of “Professor of Sport Psychology” at Sheffield Hallam University’s Centre for Sport and Exercise Science (United Kingdom) in April 1999. He attended the Barcelona and Athens Olympics, the Victoria and Manchester Commonwealth Games and has been a consultant at World Championships in eight different sports. Dr Maynard is also the director of the RYA World Class Performance and World Class Potential Sport Science Support Programmes and has acted as consultant to various sports associations such as the All England Women’s Lacrosse Association and the English Women’s Bowling Association. He served as the Executive Secretary of the British Association of Sport and Exercise Science (BASES) and chaired the BASES Sport Science Special Committee. Moreover, he is currently the Editor of *The Sport Psychologist* and an associate editor (performance enhancement) for the *Journal of Applied Sport Psychology*, and Director of the Centre for Sport and Exercise Science at Sheffield Hallam University.

Alex McKenzie currently works for the Hurricanes Super Rugby Team in New Zealand as the “Professional Development Manager”—a role that includes mental skills training for players. From 2001 to 2004, Dr McKenzie worked in the same role for the Highlanders Super Rugby Team in New Zealand. Prior to his work in professional rugby he was a senior lecturer in sport and exercise psychology at the School of Physical Education, University of Otago (New Zealand). He is the co-author of a “rugby” sport psychology book entitled *Thinking Rugby: Training Your Mind for Peak Performance*, and co-author of a book on “rugby” training entitled *Smart Training for Rugby: The Complete Rugby Training Guide*. Dr McKenzie has 25 years’ rugby playing experience, including 3 years’ representative rugby experience. In addition, he has 13 years’ rugby coaching experience, and 11 years’ experience teaching psychology skills to rugby players and coaches.

Eva A. Monsma is an assistant professor in the Department of Physical Education at the University of South Carolina (USA). Her experience with figure skating includes four years as Head Coach of the University of Guelph Gryphons varsity figure skating team, as well as two years of professional and six of amateur coaching in Ontario. She was also a sport psychology consultant to several adolescent female figure skaters. Her dissertation, titled “The Psychobiological Profile of Competitive Female Figure Skaters”, led to five publications involving psychological and physical factors of maturational status and timing as well as developmental correlates of self-concept and disordered eating risk.

Sean Müller is currently completing his doctoral studies at The University of Queensland (Australia) in the School of Human Movement Studies. Sean’s PhD has investigated *when* and from *where* world-class cricket batsmen pick up visual cues to anticipate bowlers’ deliveries, using a combination of video-based and field-based assessment tools. His research interests include the performance and learning of sport skills, with particular focus on perceptual skills in sport.

that time, he was psychologist to many top performers as well as being on the staffs of Olympic, Commonwealth Games and World Cup teams.

David N. Sacks earned his PhD in sport psychology at Florida State University (USA). He is currently an associate in research for the Learning Systems Institute at FSU, as well as an adjunct professor at FSU and Flagler College. Prior to assuming his present positions, he worked with children, athletes and families in a variety of capacities. He spent several years as a high school teacher and coach before serving as a counselor for ungovernable children and their families. He has also coached youth sport clubs at the local, national and international level, both in the United States and New Zealand. For the past 11 years, he has been a high school sports referee.

Sebastian Schulte is an extremely accomplished rower in the eights. In 2004 he was placed fourth in the Olympic Games, was vice-world champion in 2002 and won the World Championships Bronze Medal in 2001. He was also Under 23 World Champion in the eights in 2000 and has won a total of nine German national champion titles. Moreover, he is a member of the competitive sports committee of the German Rowing Federation (DRV), a member of the directors' board of the DRV and is the Athletes' Representative in the DRV.

John M. Silva is a professor of sport psychology in the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (USA). Dr Silva has published over 50 research-based articles, which have appeared in noted academic journals. He has served as a sport psychology consultant for athletes and teams competing at national and international level for over 25 years. Dr Silva was elected to the USA Team Handball Board of Directors in 2000 and has served on their Sports Medicine Committee since 1987. He is co-editor of two sport psychology textbooks including the widely used *Psychological Foundations of Sport*. Dr Silva has served as president of the Association for the Advancement of Applied Sport Psychology. He was the inaugural editor of the *Journal of Applied Sport Psychology*. He is a fellow in AAASP, a certified AAASP consultant, a member of the USOC Sport Psychology Registry, a Research Consortium fellow and a member of the American Psychological Association. Dr Silva has coached numerous USA Team Handball National Team players including two members of the 1996 USA Team Handball Olympic Team. He coached the Women's South Team in the 1993 Olympic Festival, and the Men's South Team, which won the Gold Medal in the 1995 Olympic Festival. In March 2004 he coached the Carolina THC to the USA Team Handball Collegiate National Championship. As a participant, Dr Silva played on the Carolina Team Handball Club Team that won a Bronze Medal at the US National Championships in 1991.

Robert N. Singer After receiving his PhD from Ohio State University, Dr Singer was on the faculty at different universities, most notably Florida State University, for 17 years and then at the University of Florida for 16 years. He served as a chair of the Department of Exercise and Sport Sciences at that university, and is presently professor emeritus in the Departments of Applied Physiology and Kinesiology. His research in general has dealt with cognitive processes and learner/performance strategies involved in skill acquisition and high levels of skill. His publications include over 200 research, scientific and professional articles, and 25 chapters in books. His last book publication is the *Handbook of Sport Psychology*. Dr Singer has served as Head of the Sport Psychology Division of the first Sports Medicine Committee of the United States Olympic Committee. He has been elected President of the Division 47 of the APA as well as President of the American Academy of Kinesiology and Physical Education. As Past-President of the International Society of Sport

Psychology for eight years, he remains actively involved in international developments and the advancement of sport psychology. His career has been awarded with various prizes including the Distinguished Contributions to the Science of Exercise of Sport and Exercise Psychology award in 1999 by the Division 47 of the APA.

Dave Smith is Senior Lecturer in Sport and Exercise Psychology at University of Chester in the United Kingdom. Dr Smith has worked with numerous body builders, both as a coach and consultant, and has had several recent papers published in scientific journals on psychological aspects of body-building. He is a member of the Advisory Boards of both the

publications and has given more than 500 workshops and presentations throughout North America and Europe.

Gershon Tenenbaum is currently Professor of Sport and Exercise Psychology at Florida State University (USA). He served as the President of the International Society of Sport Psychology between the years 1997 and 2001 and, since 1996 to the present, as the Editor of the *International Journal of Sport and Exercise Psychology*. He is a member of numerous scientific societies in the fields of sport and exercise psychology and statistics, and a member of the editorial boards, and reviewer for 16 journals. Dr Tenenbaum has published more than 150 articles in peer-refereed journals. He published 40 book chapters, and edited two English books (*The Practice of Sport Psychology* and *Brain and Body in Sport and Exercise—Biofeedback Applications in Performance Enhancement* with Blumenstein and Bar-Eli), and six books in the Hebrew language. Dr Tenenbaum has received several scientific honorary and meritorious awards for contributions to science and practice, including the 1987 Award for Meritorious Contribution to Educational Practice through Research (*Journal of Educational Research*) and the ISSP Honor Award (1997).

Robert Weinberg is a professor at Miami University in Ohio (USA). Before coming to Miami University, Weinberg was a professor in the Department of Kinesiology at the University of North Texas from 1978 to 1992 including being Regents Professor from 1988 to 1992. He was also voted one of the top 10 sport psychology specialists in North America by his peers. Dr Weinberg has published approximately 135 journal articles, contributed 20 book chapters, and published 7 books, as well as presenting more than 300 refereed and invited papers at sport and exercise psychology conferences. He has served as president of both the North American Society for the Psychology of Sport and Physical Activity and the Association for the Advancement of Applied Sport Psychology. He is the former Editor of the *Journal of Applied Sport Psychology* and has served on a variety of editorial boards of major journals in the field. He is a certified consultant, member of the United States Olympic Committee Sport Psychology Registry, and a fellow in the American Academy for Kinesiology and Physical Education.

Len Zaichkowsky is a professor of education, Professor of Psychiatry and Graduate Medical Sciences and Head of Graduate Training in Sport and Exercise Psychology in "Mental Health and Behavioral Medicine" at the Boston University School of Medicine (USA). He holds a joint appointment in the School of Education and School of Medicine and is Director of the Sport Psychology Clinic in the BU Department of Athletics. He has authored or edited seven books, with the most recent being *Medical and Psychological Aspects of Sport and Exercise*, and has published over 80 papers on sport psychology, research design and related topics in scholarly journals or books, plus numerous magazine and newspaper columns on applied aspects of sport psychology. Dr Zaichkowsky played, coached and refereed hockey before going into academia. Actively involved with USA hockey and the development of young hockey players, for 20 years he has served as the consulting sport psychologist for the Boston University Terriers team, and for 3 years served as the consulting psychologist for Harvard University Women's hockey team. He has also consulted for the National Hockey League Player's Association, and the Calgary Flames (2002–2003).

Foreword

Jaume Cruz Feliu

Professor of Sport Psychology, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, Spain

Psychological training and counselling with athletes, coaches, referees and others involved in the sports environment should promote a series of psychological strategies to cope with practices and competitions with greater guarantees of success. With this in mind, *The Sport Psychologist's Handbook* offers a series of intervention programmes, specific to each sport, which highlight the need for a greater specialisation in Sport Psychology according to the psychological demands of the different sporting disciplines.

The focus of this text is novel, since the majority of sport psychology manuals published

xxii

FOREWORD

- (c) *When* is the most appropriate moment to carry out the intervention?
- (d) *Why* use certain techniques and intervention programmes instead of other alternatives?
- (e) *Who* will receive the interventions and *who* will carry them out? and
- (f) *How* are these interventions to be conducted?

To respond adequately to these questions, sport psychologists must have sufficient knowledge of psychology, applied sport sciences and the sport itself. Moreover, when working with elite athletes, psychologists must take into consideration the values and identity of these athletes when carrying out interventions, since "sport psychology interventions must fit within the value system of the athlete and be congruent with the meaning that activity has for that individual", as indicated by Balagué (1999, p. 91).

The aforementioned reflections allow us to state, as suggested by Smoll and Smith in Chapter 2 of this book, that: "The sport environment is an important milieu for psychosocial development and adaptation. An increasing number of sport psychologists have thus focused on the impact of competition on athletes' personal development." Taking this into account, I believe it is not all about athletes' performance in applied sport psychology. In fact, there is something previous—such as athletes' personal and psychosocial development, shaped by their relationships with others around them (parents, coaches, peers, officials and umpires) within the youth sports environment—meaning sport psychologists must bear in mind three goals, as previously outlined (Cruz, 1992):

- (1) The psychological training of coaches of young and elite athletes;
- (2) The elaboration of programmes for young athletes with an educational focus; and
- (3) The elaboration of specific psychological preparation programmes for each sport.

Consequently, to begin with, sport psychologists should carry out an indirect intervention with athletes, counselling parents within the sporting facility, and coaches, in those psychological aspects which may be incorporated into the athletes' daily training. Second, sport psychologists must elaborate educative psychological training programmes for young athletes, with the aim of them developing the necessary skills for peak performance sport. This preparation will avoid some drop-outs, given that competition eliminates not only those athletes with less developed physical or sporting skills, but also those who have not known how to cope with the ever increasing demands of high performance. Third, sport psychologists must elaborate and apply specific psychological training programmes for each sport, which are sufficiently flexible to be adapted to the diverse requirements of each individual athlete, as suggested in the various and intriguing chapters of *The Sport Psychologist's Handbook*.

Finally, it must be highlighted that if psychological training programmes are elaborated with an educative focus, respect the values of athletes and are introduced at an early stage in youth sport to complement physical training, not only will the majority of psychological risks of peak performance sport be avoided, but also such psychological preparation will prove useful to athletes in successfully coping with competitive situations in other aspects of their professional or academic life. In reading *The Sport Psychologist's Handbook*, I believe that applied sport psychologists will find interesting ideas and suggestions for carrying out their work in accordance with these principles.

REFERENCES

Andersen, M. (2000) Introduction. In M. Andersen (ed.), *Doing Sport Psychology* (pp. XIII–XVII). Champaign, IL: Human Kinetics.

Balagué, G. (1999). Understanding identity, value and meaning when working with elite athletes. *Sport Psychologist*, 13, 89–98.

Cruz, J. (1992). El asesoramiento y la intervención psicológica en deportistas olímpicos. (Psychological counselling and intervention with Olympic athletes). *Revista de Psicología del Deporte*, 2, 41–46.

Dosil, J. (2002). *El psicólogo del deporte: asesoramiento e intervención*. (The sport psychologist: counseling and intervention). Madrid: Síntesis.

Vanek, M. & Cratty, B. (1970). *Psychology and the Superior Athlete*. London: Collier.

Preface

Over the last few decades sport psychology has undergone sustained development. Various elements may be used to analyse the evolution of this area of knowledge: from an academic perspective, an ever increasing number of training courses, master's and doctoral programmes related to sport psychology are being offered; the research field has been consolidated and various scientific journals have emerged in this area of study; sport psychology congresses and publications are a frequent occurrence year after year; and sport psychology associations have spread throughout the world, with international and national organisations, etc. Nevertheless, as time goes on, one subject remains unsettled: the applied field.

The value of psychological aspects to those within the sporting context (coaches, athletes, managers, referees, etc.) is undeniable, and yet few support the integration of the sport psychology figure within teams and clubs. This distance between sport psychology professionals and their subjects within the sporting environment is the result of certain attributes, still attached to our profession (limiting activity to a clinical focus and theoretical aspects, associations with laboratory experiments, etc.) and, principally, an ignorance of what sport psychologists can really provide in each sporting discipline (both for improved performance and increased wellbeing).

Many texts have been published in an attempt to solve this "problem". The majority of these publications focus on how sport psychologists should work, how to use psychological techniques and the description of case studies illustrating the most effective procedures. Currently, we are able to contemplate a base of knowledge between sport psychologists which allows them to guarantee a service in accordance with the most common requirements demanded of them. However, this has not been sufficient to achieve the inclusion and total acceptance of sport psychology. The challenge we have faced over the years is knowing how to transfer theoretical knowledge to the specific field of sport and, more specifically, to each sporting discipline. Many sport psychologists have failed to effectively market their product, believing that "simply" being a good professional is enough to work in the applied field. Conducting quality marketing may prove one of the keys to the sport psychologist being more widely accepted in the future, as just another member of the technical staff of teams and athletes. To achieve this, it becomes fundamental to follow a double strategy: having a good product and knowing how to sell it. Having a good product refers to sport psychologists being highly qualified specialists in the applied field. Therefore, it is necessary to know how to apply psychology, be familiar with sport sciences and, principally, delve deeper into the uniqueness of the sporting discipline in which one is to work. Selling this product is a much



Acknowledgements

The adventure of editing a book is similar to training a sports team. At the beginning of the season (when the book is still just a project), a proposal is made to a sponsor (the publishers) with the objectives we aim to achieve. Once they accept the initial ideas, it becomes fundamental to form a good team (contributors). From this moment on, the regular league matches begin (the process of creating the work), in which each member of the team has a function, and depending on how they carry it out, we achieve one outcome or another. In our case, we have had the opportunity to “train” a great team, who have performed extraordinarily throughout our particular season. For this reason, I direct my words of thanks to the 43 contributors who have made this text possible. They have been the authentic stars in this “sport” of writing. Secondly, I would like to mention the support given to me from the beginning of this project by Manuel Vazquez. He has played the role of second coach, evaluating everything concerned with this publication with precision. Thirdly, I give thanks to my assistant Suzanne Hasler, since without her help it would have been impossible to write the chapters I took on. I would also like to express my satisfaction at working with Gillian Lesley, the editor at Wiley, whose kind words have helped me to remain motivated at every moment; as well as Deborah Eggleton and Claire Ruston, who have always been ready to collaborate. And I couldn’t forget the person who has lived with me through the different production phases of this work, my wife Olaia. She, along with my family, are always there when I need them and are the basic support of all my work.

Finally, as any good coach would do at the end of a season, it’s necessary to carry out a final balance. Without a doubt, we will find aspects to improve on in the next edition, but needless to say, we can conclude by saying that this team has been an authentic “dream team”. Thank you so much to all of you.

PART I

Introduction to Working with Athletes

Copyrighted material

CHAPTER 1

Applied Sport Psychology: A New Perspective

Joaquín Dosil

University of Vigo, Spain

INTRODUCTION

Traditionally, coaches and athletes have focused their efforts on physical training. Over time, however, the technical, tactical and psychological aspects have gained a more important role. Despite psychology being perceived as one of the key factors to peak performance and wellbeing in sport, few systematically train this facet.

Since applied sport psychology has yet to achieve the same development as in those areas dedicated to education and research, new approaches are required to get closer to the needs of athletes and people in sport, definitively opening the doors to the incorporation of the sport psychology figure in clubs and teams. The current situation in peak performance sport reflects an increasing equality between the physical, technical and tactical domains, with psychology excelling on many occasions. Along these lines, and as already defended in other texts (Dosil, 2002), a greater specialization is required in the applied field, in which psychologists are able to confront any situation presented to them within the sport they work in. To achieve this, in the coming years there should be an emergence of authentic sport psychology specialists in football, basketball, tennis, golf, etc. with perfect knowledge of their sport and a greater ability to adapt their skills to it. This idea constitutes the driving force behind this publication, which endeavours to serve as a handbook for psychologists, bringing within their reach the essential elements to commence work in different sports.

This chapter is developed on these assumptions, gathering the basic characteristics of mental training, going through an athlete's psychological preparation and reflecting on one of the future trends in the applied field: mental peak performance. The final part of the chapter presents two applied sport psychology training programmes: the field and clinical applied learning programmes, which stand out for the success they are having incorporating new psychologists into the sports world.

The Sport Psychologist's Handbook: A Guide for Sport-Specific Performance Enhancement.
Edited by Joaquín Dosil. © 2006 John Wiley & Sons, Ltd.

Copyrighted material

AN OVERVIEW OF MENTAL TRAINING

Mental training involves providing athletes with a series of psychological strategies for improving their ability to confront training and competition with greater guarantees of success. Therefore, it is a specific task aimed at increasing the performance and wellbeing of athletes or anyone involved in the sports context. The principal idea of mental training, as with physical preparation, is that a determined number of hours are needed to acquire psychological strategies, for which a weekly practice session may be suitable. In the majority of cases, such dedication to maximum mental development is impractical given the structure of sport and the current situation of applied sport psychology, which limits the training possibilities. In reality, if the aim is for athletes to become mental control specialists (just as they are physical control specialists), it becomes necessary to perform psychological training on a daily basis, on the premise that the greater the dedication, the greater the improvement will be. However, in the event that athletes do decide to become involved with psychological training in a similar way to their physical preparation (e.g. two hours daily), would sport psychologists be prepared to offer such an intensive service?

Mental training entails a series of difficulties experienced by both those who direct it, psychologists, and those who receive it, athletes, and others involved in sport. Psychologists require an extensive experience-based training in the applied field, which is still not widespread (in the second part of the chapter we will see two possible training programmes), as well as an in-depth knowledge of psychology, other sport sciences and, of course, the sport in which they work. On the other hand, mainly due to an ignorance of what mental training consists of and how it is carried out, members of the sporting "community" remain unaware of its potential, impeding its integration into daily training. The few who do appreciate its importance usually regard it as "something" suitable for use on isolated occasions when problems arise.

These circumstances force psychologists to adapt mental training to the conditions they find themselves working in. Various texts have described possible programmes which sport psychologists may use as a guide for their assessment and intervention work with clubs and athletes (e.g. Tenenbaum, 2001; Weinberg & Williams, 2001). However, they should consider every circumstance as unique, requiring them to adapt to the context and individuals with whom they are working. The objectives professional sport psychologists should set will vary according to these conditions, becoming more or less ambitious depending

APPLIED SPORT PSYCHOLOGY: A NEW PERSPECTIVE

5

- *Clinical intervention* The classic option in sport psychology. It stems from clinical psychology and involves carrying out psychological training in the office or consultancy. Although the clinic can be used to assess and treat athletes, important contextual information is easily lost. Any myths surrounding clinical psychological work should be dispelled, especially when many athletes still struggle with the idea of going to a sport psychology clinic to improve performance rather than solve problems, which continues to be the most frequent reason for their visits (e.g. lack of motivation to train, lack of consistency, being overly negative, becoming nervous, etc.). In the office, while priority should be given to athletes' problems, it remains an exceptional opportunity to inform them of how psychological training can increase performance and well being.
- *Field intervention* involves going into the athletics environment to perform psychological assessments of coaches and athletes. The principal objective of this form of psychological training is to integrate psychologists into the teams with which they are collaborating, operating in their natural setting and providing them with strategies which adapt to their day-to-day situations. It is advisable for use in those sports where successful clinical assessment is more difficult. On occasions, problems may arise when sport psychologists have no suitable place to meet with athletes (i.e. an office) and, to some extent, lose the confidentiality this setting would provide. This has certain repercussions in the training of some strategies which require time to be learned and an adequate location in which to work on them correctly (e.g. relaxation or visualization).
- *On-line intervention* is one of the lesser developed methods in psychology and is scarcely employed in sport psychology. Nevertheless, various studies have shown its use to be just as effective as the more traditional forms of guidance, if not more so (Zizzi and Perna, 2002). As demonstrated in other studies (Dosil and García-Prieto, 2004), it may become one of the professional possibilities of the future since it offers certain advantages over the aforementioned approaches (e.g. confidentiality, anonymity for those athletes who wish to remain unknown, speed of response/treatment, etc.). However, this form of guidance is limited in the requests and athletes it can respond to. On some occasions psychologists need to consult with athletes in person or refer cases to another professional. Nevertheless, to guide coaches (by way of "psychological advice"), give simple action guidelines to some athletes, work using records, etc. it is extremely effective, making it a tool of undoubted value in present-day sport psychology.

The success of these three types of intervention lies in the skills of sport psychologists to adapt the most suitable method to the needs of teams or athletes. Ideally, all three approaches should be employed to achieve maximum performance in psychological assessments, since the multitude of situations experienced in sport will demand one method or another. For example, as can be seen in Chapter 7 on football, what is known as the "mixed model" (Dosil, 2004) may be employed, which encompasses characteristics of all three techniques. Initially, resources provided by email are used to gather information about teams and coaches, followed up with direct observation and field interviews where individual and group assessments may be carried out. Subsequently, clinical or "on-line" intervention may be appropriate for some athletes or coaches.

PSYCHOLOGICAL INTERVENTION LEVELS AND THE ATHLETE'S PSYCHOLOGICAL LEVEL

The use of the three aforementioned intervention systems depends on the depth of psychological training required. Currently, two "levels" of sport psychology intervention are usually employed: problem solving (level 1) and mental training (level 2). At the first level, many studies have focused on identifying the most effective methods of solving problems common to athletes; while mental training, yet to become "standardized" in the current sports climate, involves dedicating a specific amount of time to learning strategies and improving psychological skills throughout the season. This level of assessment and intervention is frequently found in training schedules developed in high performance centres, where athletes are able to dedicate time on a weekly basis to psychological training programmes, or when national teams spend time "focused" in holding camps prior to representing their country in international championships. Nevertheless, while agreeing on the need for the two "classic" levels of psychological intervention, this text proposes a third level, superior to the previous two, which may be termed "mental peak performance". This level of guidance is still underdeveloped and few sport psychologists approach it, either for lack of knowledge or for its infeasibility in the current circumstances. Table 1.1 describes the differences between the three techniques.

Levels 1 and 2 have been well documented in sport psychology scientific literature (e.g. for clinical treatment, see Andersen, 2002; or for the planning of psychological training, see Weinberg & Williams, 2001). The majority of applied studies refer to these levels, assuming that athletes turn to sport psychologists to solve personal or sport-based problems, or to train skills which allow them to improve their performance. The limitation of these levels lies in the fact that only a certain improvement is achieved, with psychologists acting as a

Table 1.1 Psychological intervention levels

Level	Objective	Consequences
Level 1	Solution of athletes' problems	Faced with a problem, sport psychologists provide one or more techniques which allow athletes to find solutions to their problems (e.g. problems sleeping prior to competition: they are shown an effective relaxation technique which enables them to resolve their predicament).
Level 2	Basic mental skills training	This is used to avoid rather than solve problems, giving athletes a series of psychological strategies to employ in different situations, depending on the requirements (e.g. to sleep well prior to a competition: control their arousal levels, perform visualization, maintain concentration, etc.).
Level 3	Mental peak performance	Athletes achieve maximum mental control, producing optimum performance in any circumstance. They have internalized the techniques and apply them consciously or unconsciously in the face of adverse situations (e.g. capacity to sleep in any situation).

not have received any form of psychological training, or had any contact with a psychologist. Level 1 athletes will have solved some problems related to their sporting activities through attending a sport psychologist. At level 2, athletes will have carried out a mental training programme and acquired the basic psychological strategies to confront training and competition. Finally, level 3 embodies those sportspeople who have assimilated the psychological strategies and adapt them to any training or competition situation, strengthening their performance. In a situation such as that described in Table 1.2, training at level 3 would be based on progressive work with athletes: having evaluated their ability to get to sleep and studied their habits and routines, they would move to the strategy learning phase to be taught thought control and relaxation (e.g. through visualization). Once they have mastered this, they would begin applying these techniques in varying situations, gradually increasing with difficulty (e.g. (1) sleeping with a light on outside the bedroom, (2) sleeping with the bedside lamp switched on, (3) sleeping with the bedroom light on ...).

The psychological "level" athletes can reach will vary according to the psychological preparation they receive. Nevertheless, some will display similar psychological strengths to those who have been working with sport psychologists over time, without ever having had any form of guidance. This can be considered normal, similar to what occurs in the physical domain. Just as some athletes require more training than others to develop their physical skills, some need more preparation than others to develop their psychological abilities.

As suggested in the introduction, one of the characteristics common to all top sportspeople is their excellent physical condition. Although this is achieved through years of hard training, they are often blessed with certain natural abilities and a physique suited to their event. Likewise, before beginning any form of mental training, athletes will already possess certain psychological skills, usually dependent on key experiences in their life. The explanation for athletes who display psychological qualities to confront training and competition without ever having been to a psychologist is usually related to key experiences or sporting moments in which their capacity to confront situations was strengthened (e.g. a basketball player who learned to "forget" his family problems in his childhood by doing sport will perhaps have a greater ability to focus on the task). By contrast, other athletes will have had damaging experiences which have limited their psychological growth (through not having learned to confront situations). This first group of athletes are frequently described as "tough athletes", while the latter are often called "soft athletes", referring to their mental strength. The role of the sport psychologist is to strengthen the "toughness" of the tough-minded and "toughen up" the soft-minded. Between one extreme and another fall the "other athletes", and in these cases the sport psychologist can develop a *subjective scale of mental "toughness"*, measuring (e.g. 1–10) the psychological level (mental "toughness") of athletes and obtaining the preliminary information to commence work with them. This scale can be complemented with the athletes' and coaches' perceptions of mental "toughness".

Employing this method, it becomes necessary to follow a personalized plan of psychological training (in group as well as individual sports), with the aim of adapting as much as possible to the circumstances of each athlete. The first step to creating the outline of this psychological work is carrying out a detailed study of the sport, its context and its components.

The typical outline of mental training is established from a *Psychological Guidance and Intervention Programme* (PGIP) consisting of four stages (Table 1.3): evaluation, planning, psychological preparation of training sessions and psychological preparation of competitions (seen in more detail in Chapter 5).